Course Code / Name: SA330 Animal Husbandry

Background and Rationale

- To provide students with knowledge and skills in various domesticated animal production and husbandry practices and the integration of livestock in crop and tree production.

Learning Outcomes

At the completion of the course students should be able to:

- Understand the importance and classes of domestic animals;
- Understand the practices and systems of rearing domesticated farm animals;
- Understand livestock integration in crop and tree production;
- Apply the principles of animal production and health.

Course Contents

1. **Importance and classes of domesticated farm animals:** Types and breeds of domesticated farm animals, populations, distributions and production potential in Zambia and the Sub-Saharan region.
2. **Practices and systems of rearing domesticated farm animals:** Dairy, beef, pigs, goats, sheep, rabbits and poultry; factors limiting production in each case.
3. **Animal feeds:** Different feed types; feedstuffs composition and properties; feeding and grazing system requirements and practices; feed (ration) formulation and production, Herbage intake and animal performance.
4. **Pasture and range management:** Types of pasture; different production and management practices; benefits to the livestock industry.
5. **Animal health:** Animal diseases and parasites; symptoms and causes of diseases; infection process and transmission; treatment and prevention; nutritional deficiencies and their effects; parasitic and microbial effects; policy and disease control.
6. **Conversion of animals to retail and food products: -** Slaughtering of animals, Packaging and sanitation; Broiler and egg production; principles of incubation and hatchery; types of animal products.
7. **Housing and facilities designs:** Basic domesticated animals housing designs, maintenance systems, and sanitary issues.
8. **Basics on integrated agriculture;** livestock integration in crop and tree production

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Recommended References

1. McDonalds P., Edwards R.A. and Greenhalgh J.F.D. 2002, Animal Nutrition, 6th Edition, Longmans UK. ISBN 0582443887,9780582443990
2. Payne W.J.A. 1994 An Introduction to Animal Husbandry in the Tropics 4th Edition, ELBS Longman, Singapore ISBN 0582212758
3. Hall H.T.B. 1994. Diseases and Parasites of Livestock in the Tropics 3rd Edition, Longman Scientific and Technical, London. ISBN 0582775140, 9780582775145
4. Humphreys L.R. 1978 Tropical Pastures and Fodder Crops. Intermediate Tropical Agriculture Series, Longman UK, ISBN 058260303. Digitalised: 12th Feb 2009

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